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A guide to using Edits,
Meta's CapCut rival for
short-form video editing

Meta recently [released a new video editing app](#) for creators called Edits. The new app is designed to rival ByteDance's CapCut, a popular short-form video-editing app used by many creators.

Meta first shared that it was working on Edits back in January after ByteDance-owned CapCut was removed from U.S. app stores when the TikTok ban momentarily went into effect. Although the app has since come back online and is available to download, TikTok's future in the U.S. remains uncertain, so Meta is ready to capitalize on CapCut's possible absence in the future with its new Edits app.

IMAGE CREDITS: META

We've created this guide to walk you through the app and the different features it offers, and we provide an overview of how it compares to CapCut.

How to get started with the app



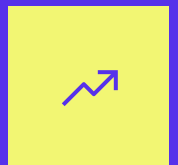
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Edits is available to download on both [iOS](#) and [Android](#). Once you download the app and open it, you will be asked to log in with your Instagram account.

From there you will see five main tabs: Ideas, Inspiration, Projects, Record, and Insights. The Ideas tab offers creators a space to jot down ideas for new videos and save reels to a collection, and the Inspiration tab features a hub for discovering trending audios and other popular reels.

The Projects tab is where creators can store and revisit the videos they currently have in progress. This tab is also where creators can upload videos from their phone's camera roll.

The Record tab lets creators start filming video content right within Edits.

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Lastly, the Insights tab gives creators an overview of how their content is performing by surfacing metrics like views, reach, and follower counts.

Tools and features available on Edits

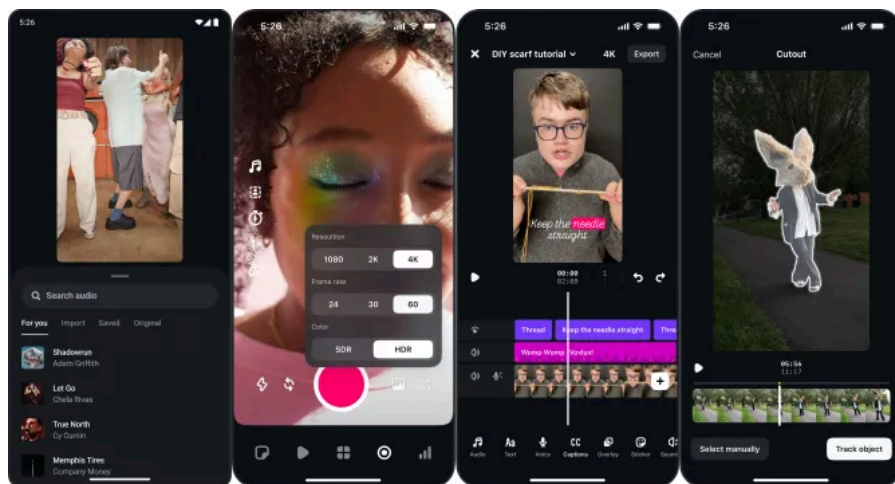


IMAGE CREDITS: META

Green screen: Replace and edit the background of your videos with one tap.

Timeline: Precisely arrange and adjust clips.

Captions: Add automatic captions to your videos in multiple languages.

Audio library: Add music from Instagram's library to your videos.

Cutouts: Isolate specific objects with precision tracking.

Animate: Turn static images into videos using AI.

Apply all: Apply filters, effects, transitions, and adjustments to all of your clips at once.

Timeline frame rate selector: Convert your video to the frame rate you want in order to enhance playback smoothness.

Alignment guides: Ensure viewers can see the important parts of your video when posted and accurately position text, emoji, or other elements.

Beat markers: Add auto-detected beat markers to help you align clips, text, and overlays with audio when editing.

Filters: Choose from 30 different filter options to add a unique look to your videos.

Transitions: Choose from 30 different transitions to connect different video clips in a seamless way.

Teleprompter: Follow your written script while recording.

Restyle: Use AI to change the look and style of your video with a library of presets.

Keyframes: Animate the position, rotation, and scale of clips.

Cut Silences: Automatically remove unwanted silence from reels.

Import Audio from Files: Add your own unique sounds directly into edits.

Clip Preview: Preview clips while you're recording from the camera.

Share drafts to DMs: Collaborate with others by sending Edits drafts directly via Instagram DM.

How does Edits differ from CapCut?

While both Edits and CapCut are great options for editing short-form videos, there are some differences between the two services.

CapCut offers more robust editing options, including AI features, than Edits does. Of course, this can be expected since Edits is a lot newer than CapCut. Meta will likely continue to build out Edits over the next months and years, so we can expect to see more advanced functionality in the future. It's also worth noting that CapCut has a more extensive music library compared to Edits.

Another difference is the fact that Edits currently doesn't have a subscription offering (for now), but CapCut does. While CapCut offers a free version, some of its advanced tools are locked behind a paid subscription. Edits is free to use, but this will likely change in the future, as Instagram head [Adam Mosseri has stated](#) that later versions of Edits may include paid features.

In addition, while CapCut is available on the web, Edits is mobile-only. However, this could change in the future.

Update: This story originally ran in May and is updated regularly with new information.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#) [🦋](#) [in](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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IMAGE CREDITS: FOCUS FRIEND

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Hank Green's Focus Friend app is climbing the App Store charts — and it's extremely cute

Amanda Silberling — 10:36 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

You must stay focused. You cannot open TikTok, or Instagram, or whatever little phone games you like to play. If you fail, you will make an anthropomorphic bean very sad, because its knitting project depends on your ability to stay focused.

This is the premise of [Focus Friend](#), a productivity app created by [Honey B Games](#) and [Hank Green](#), the longtime online creator/entrepreneur/educator/[sock salesman](#). Though the app was soft launched last month, Focus Friend is only now gaining momentum on the App Store charts — likely because Green and his brother, author John Green, are [posting about it](#)

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[more](#) — reaching No. 4 among all free apps and No. 2 among productivity apps.

[@hankgreen1](#)

Your Deserve a Focus Friend

 [original sound – Hank Green](#)

Focus Friend, which is available on [iOS](#) and [Android](#), has the bones of a typical productivity app. It invites you to set a timer on your phone, which will temporarily prevent you from opening certain apps (on iOS, the “Deep Focus Mode” setting connects to your own screen time settings, where you can designate which apps to block).

But what makes Focus Friend different is that it assigns you a new friend — a little bean — which you can give a cute name, like Garbanzo, or Susan Bean Anthony, or Eda (it’s short for Edamame).

Your bean needs help focusing on its knitting. And it can only focus if you refrain from opening the apps that distract you from your work. If you successfully complete your focus session, your bean will give you in-game points (socks), which you can use to buy decorations for its room — because the only thing more motivating than helping a bean knit is to buy it a cute poster for its wall.

Focus Friend has a lot in common with [Finch](#), a popular self-care app that incentivizes users to maintain healthy habits by giving them a virtual bird companion. Your bird grows when you complete certain tasks that you set for yourself, like drinking water, brushing your teeth, or cleaning your room. Like the Tamagotchis of yore, these apps exploit our desire to protect a cute bundle of pixels by doing stuff that’s good for us.

Focus Friend is functional as a free app, but you can pay to give your bean different skins — you can

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make your bean look like a cat (a “Kitt-ney Bean”) or a jelly bean, for example. There’s also a subscription that allows your bean to knit scarves, which can be exchanged for premium decorations. Green [posted](#) on Bluesky that Focus Friend is “very much trying to be an ad-free experience because the mobile ad ecosystem kinda blows.” But the app still has to make money to compensate the employees who brought our beans to life.



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Amanda Silberling

Senior Writer |

Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She has also...

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Sarah Perez — 10:16 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Newsletter subscription platform Substack will begin taking advantage of an option on the U.S. App Store that allows users to make purchases outside of Apple's in-app purchasing system. This functionality is permitted by a [change to the App Store's rules in May](#), as a result of [Epic Games' antitrust lawsuit](#) against the tech giant.

Since then, a number of top apps have moved to offer in-app purchase links that point to their own websites, including [Spotify](#), [Patreon](#), and the [Amazon Kindle](#) app, among others.

In Substack's case, support for external payments will benefit both the company, which no longer has to pay the App Store a commission on those web sales, and consumers, who will have access to reduced pricing. Meanwhile, Substack creators will be able to offer their readers the option of whether they want the convenience of Apple's in-app payments system (IAP) or the web payment option, which is now accessible without having to leave the app.

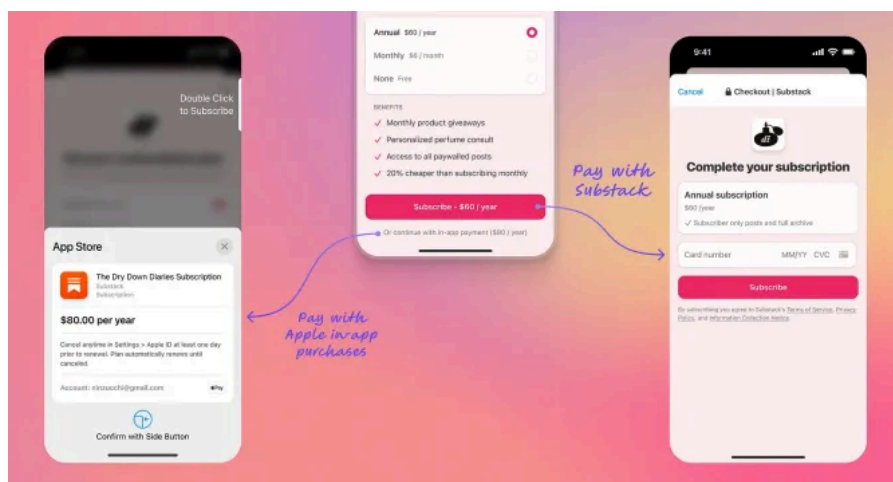
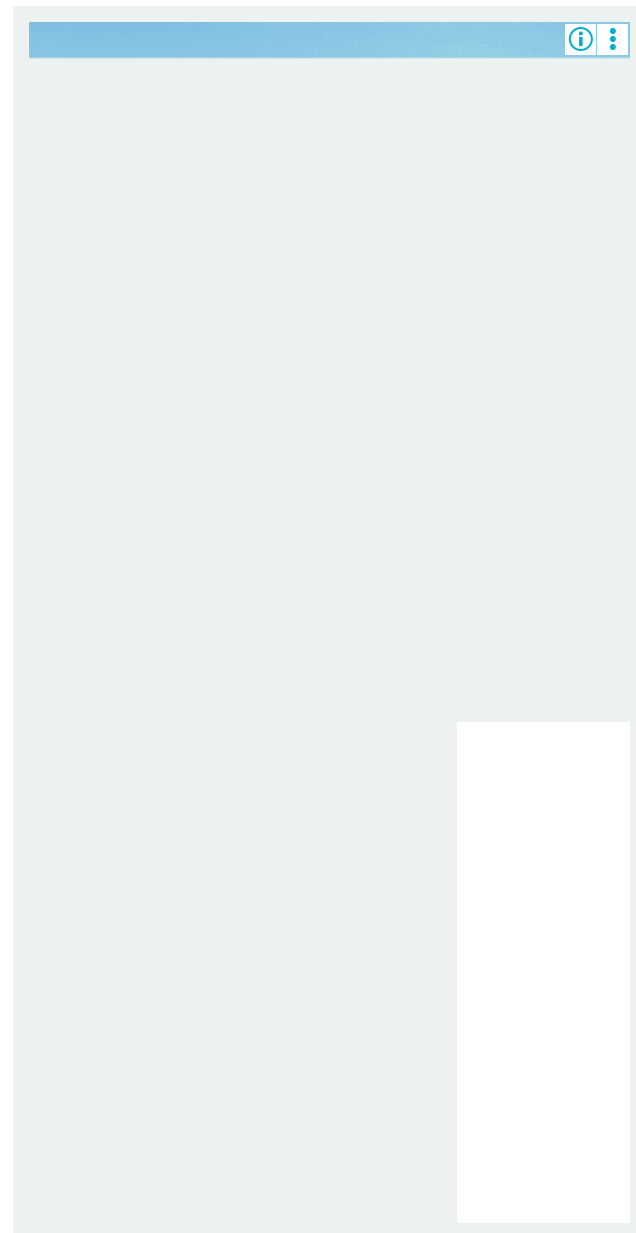


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

Substack explains it will automatically adjust its customers' iOS app price higher to account for Apple's fees, allowing creators to take home the same amount of money as a web subscription. However, Substack writers can disable this feature if they choose. (Substack will continue to take its own



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Aisha Malik - 3 hours ago

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Spotify's latest feature lets you add your own transitions to playlists

Sarah Perez - 6 hours ago

10% fee based on the web subscription price, as before.)

The company said in its blog post that it's also offering its writers "migration tools." We originally reported that these could help migrate users from one payments platform to another, but Substack reached out to correct this. Instead, it said that the tools are meant to help creators access billing information for Apple-managed subscriptions if they ever leave the platform.

Currently, more than 30,000 publications on the platform have in-app purchases enabled; Substack says early tests of the expanded set of payment options have driven a boost in paid sign-ups. It did not, however, share specific numbers related to this.

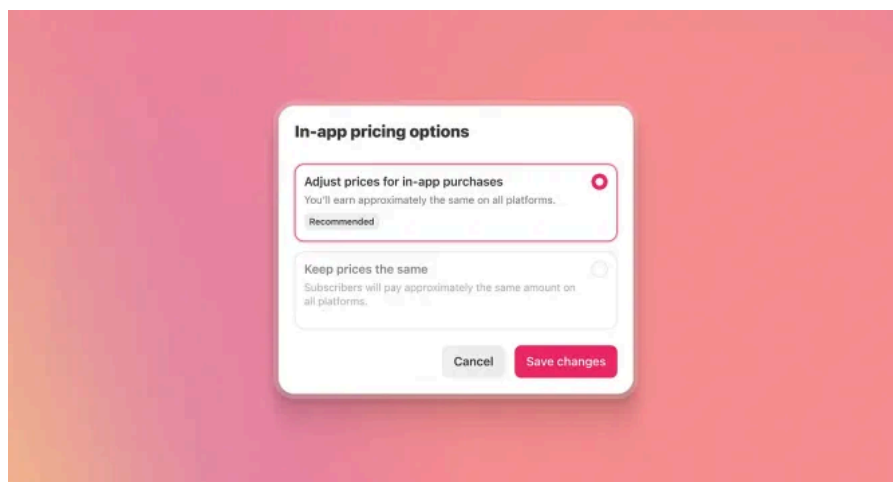


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

The public launch of the external payments option will only impact new Substack subscriptions. Substack writers don't have to take any action unless they want to lower the prices for those using Apple's payments system.

Per Apple's App Store rules, fully opting out of offering IAP is not allowed.

While the changes impact the Substack app in the U.S., the company says it's still evaluating if it makes sense to switch to the more complex rules Apple

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OpenAI launches a sub-\$5 ChatGPT plan in India

Ivan Mehta - 12 hours ago

offers in the EU and U.K. for developers who want to forgo IAP.

Updated after publication to correct and clarify how the migration tools work.

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor |

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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X's declining Android app installs are hurting subscription revenue

Sarah Perez — 1:49 PM PDT · August 18, 2025

Elon Musk's X is struggling on Android devices in terms of new installs, even while App Store downloads grow, according to new data from app intelligence provider Appfigures. In July 2025, X downloads on Google Play saw a significant decline, as new installs dropped by 44% year-over-year worldwide, even as iOS downloads grew by 15%.

This steep drop in installs is pulling down X's overall average, leading to a 26% decrease in total mobile downloads year-over-year as of July. That's still slightly better than the month prior, when total downloads had fallen by 35%, thanks to another sharp drop in Android downloads, which were then down by nearly half (49%) year-over-year.

New X Downloads on Mobile by Month

Estimated Downloads • Worldwide • App Store and Google Play



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The firm didn't speculate on what's causing the decline on Android devices beyond suggesting that the X app on Android is known to be a sore spot for the company. Recently hired [X head of product Nikita Bier](#), known for growth hacking teen social apps like [Gas](#) and [TBH](#) (then [selling them](#)), has hinted that X is looking to address issues on Android, where its app is [notoriously buggy](#) and [often crashes](#).

In a post on the platform, Bier [announced](#) that X was hiring for its "Android Dream Team" to work on rebuilding the X Android app. He also recently posted that X's iOS app [had just seen a record week in terms of installs](#), perhaps hoping to draw attention away from the large Android slump.

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IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

It's not clear where would-be X Android users are going. Rival Bluesky has seen slowing growth in recent months, and its Google Play app pulled in just 119,000 downloads in July. That's nowhere near the millions that install X on iOS or Android every month. However, Meta's Threads daily active users

have been [catching up to X on mobile devices](#), so, possibly, some Android users could be accounted for there.

In addition to the drop in Google Play installs, X is struggling to grow its subscription revenue, Appfigures found.

In July, X earned \$16.9 million in net revenue, down from the \$18.8 million it earned in March 2025. However, that was a slight tick up from the \$16.8 million it generated in June. (Of course, X still earns the majority of its overall revenue from ads, not in-app premium subscriptions.)

While the declining demand for X on Android is partially to blame for revenue declines, X is also likely losing paying customers to Grok. The latter now has its own [stand-alone app](#) that attracts those who were buying X subscriptions primarily for the AI perks.

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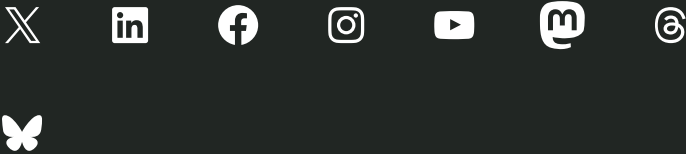
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